

“A revolution is a fight to the death between the future and the past.”

FIDEL CASTRO, SPEECH, 1961

2 January 1959

FIDEL CASTRO TAKES POWER IN CUBA

Taking advantage of popular discontent with the corrupt rule of President Fulgencio Batista, guerrilla forces led by Fidel Castro and Che Guevara took up arms in 1953 and gradually gained support despite setbacks including defeat, imprisonment, and exile. From a base in the Sierra Maestra mountains, they wore down government troops sent against them until they were finally able to take the offensive and make a triumphal entry into the capital, Havana.



△ Cuban banknote celebrating the 1959 revolution

29 July 1958 The National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) is established in the US

1959

4 October 1958 The Fifth Republic is established in France, with Charles de Gaulle as its first president



△ Poster promoting the Great Leap Forward



1926-2016
FIDEL CASTRO

After leading his guerrilla army to victory, Castro served as Cuba's prime minister until 1976 and then as President until 2008. He turned Cuba into a one-party Communist state.